

JOHN GRIMES

Professional Profile

Principal Infrastructure Engineer with 20 years in DevOps/Infrastructure, currently at Cobalt Applications. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Prometheus, CI/CD and Python.

Employment History

Principal Infrastructure Engineer, Cobalt Applications

2018–2026

- Ran the on-call rotation for 12 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.
- Hardened Kubernetes environments ahead of SOC 2, closing 12 critical findings.
- Built observability on CI/CD so teams could self-serve dashboards instead of filing tickets.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with Datadog, bringing mean time to deploy under 6 minutes.
- Reduced incident MTTR from 12 hours to under 60 minutes with better alert routing and runbooks.

LinkedIn — Site Reliability Engineer

2008–2017

- Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 4 accounts.
- Improved cluster utilisation by 60% through right-sizing and Datadog autoscaling policies.
- Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.
- Automated 12 manual runbooks, saving an estimated 30 engineer-hours per month.

DevOps Engineer, Ridgeline Analytics

2007–2008

- Cut container image sizes by 18%, shortening cold starts across the fleet.
- Introduced infrastructure-as-code with Linux, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 40 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.

Infrastructure Engineer

Fenwick Digital | 2005–2006

- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.
- Migrated 40 services to CI/CD, cutting monthly infrastructure spend by 15%.
- Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 6 previous attempts.

Platform Engineer, Amber Creek Software

2004–2004

- Ran retrospectives and drove the follow-up actions to completion, not just to the board.
- Led a team of 8 through a full replatforming with no missed delivery dates.
- Took over an unowned service, documented it and brought it back under SLO.

Education & Qualifications

Bachelor, Biology

Linchester State University | 2001–2004

Skills

Languages: Python, Go, Rust, Swift

Frameworks: TensorFlow, NumPy

Cloud & DevOps: Prometheus, CI/CD, AWS, GitHub Actions, Kubernetes, Datadog, Linux

Data: Redis, Elasticsearch

Side Projects

Personal finance tracker

Self-hosted spend tracker built with Redis. Deliberately kept the data local rather than using a hosted service.

Conference talk

Spoke on Python in production at a regional meetup, ~30 attendees.

Certificates

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — Cloud Native Computing Foundation, 2017

TensorFlow Developer Certificate — Google, 2019

Language Skills

English – Bilingual

Mandarin – Professional working proficiency

Interests

Jazz guitar, Sailing